

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Information Security Analyst | Incident Response | Threat Analysis | Security Operations

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Information Security Analyst with more than five years of hands-on operational experience protecting complex enterprise environments by identifying, analysing, and responding to security threats. I have extensive experience acting as a first responder for security incidents, monitoring and responding to Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) alerts, and analysing security data to identify trends, vulnerabilities, and attacker activity. I have deployed and managed the Microsoft security stack across an estate of 8,000 users, including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft Sentinel, and I bring deep expertise in threat hunting, vulnerability management, and security posture improvement. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and thrive in organisations where protecting customers and systems is central to the mission.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Incident Response and First Responder Operations:** NIST 800-61 incident lifecycle, on-call incident response, alert triage, containment, eradication, and recovery
- **Security Monitoring:** Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) - CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), alert monitoring and analysis
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, EDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Microsoft Security Stack:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)
- **Threat Analysis and Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat hunting, detection engineering, intelligence-led analysis
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; vulnerability trend analysis and remediation prioritisation
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), privileged access management
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** PowerShell-based playbook automation, alert enrichment, automated response workflows
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM platform
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Serve as a first responder for security incidents, monitoring Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) alerts across CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel, and leading the incident response lifecycle from initial detection through to resolution and post-incident review.
- Monitor and respond to security alerts across the enterprise estate, triaging and investigating events in real time, performing root cause analysis, and coordinating containment and recovery actions in line with NIST 800-61.
- Analyse security data from SIEM, EDR, identity, and vulnerability management platforms to identify trends, anomalous patterns, and emerging vulnerabilities, translating findings into actionable risk reduction recommendations.
- Conduct threat hunting activities using Kusto Query Language (KQL)-based SIEM queries and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactively identifying attacker activity mapped to MITRE ATT&CK tactics,

techniques, and procedures (TTPs).

- Strengthen and evolve the organisation's security posture by identifying gaps in detection coverage, recommending control improvements, and leading implementation of security enhancements across endpoint, identity, and network security domains.
- Manage Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) workflows using PowerShell-based playbooks, automating alert enrichment, initial containment, and stakeholder notification to reduce mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Lead vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), analysing vulnerability data to identify trends, prioritise remediation, and validate control effectiveness.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) platform and Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies, enforcing least-privilege access controls and reducing identity-based risk.
- Participate in on-call incident response support, ensuring consistent security coverage across the organisation during and outside business hours.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000 users, establishing centralised endpoint protection and identity threat detection to strengthen the organisation's security posture.
- Monitored and responded to security alerts across SIEM and EDR platforms, conducting first-line triage, root cause analysis, and escalation in line with documented incident response procedures.
- Analysed security data from multiple sources to identify vulnerability trends, attacker behavioural patterns, and systemic gaps in the organisation's defensive posture, presenting findings to the security leadership team.
- Conducted threat hunting exercises using MITRE ATT&CK-mapped hypotheses to proactively identify attacker activity not captured by automated alerting, discovering several instances of lateral movement and persistence techniques.
- Developed and tuned SIEM detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), reducing false positives and improving the quality and relevance of alerts surfaced to the security operations team.
- Managed vulnerability assessment programme using Nessus and AppCheck, analysing findings to identify trends and prioritise remediation of critical and high-severity vulnerabilities in collaboration with infrastructure teams.
- Managed Mimecast email security gateway, configuring anti-phishing, anti-spoofing, and data loss prevention controls to protect customer and institutional data.
- Supported Cyber Essentials Plus certification and ISO 27001 control assurance, demonstrating and evidencing security controls across endpoint, identity, and network domains.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Monitored security events across a cloud-hosted SaaS and FinTech environment, responding to alerts, conducting initial triage, and escalating confirmed incidents through a structured incident response process.
- Implemented and maintained Microsoft Azure security controls, including logging, audit trails, and access policy enforcement, supporting the organisation's ability to detect and respond to security threats.
- Managed vulnerability scanning and patch management programmes, analysing security data to identify trends, prioritise remediation, and track closure of critical vulnerabilities.
- Administered identity security controls including Single Sign-On (SSO) and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), protecting customer and corporate systems from unauthorised access.
- Supported quality assurance and infrastructure security processes, contributing to continuous improvement of the organisation's security posture and regulatory compliance.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender to 8,000 users, significantly strengthening the organisation's security posture across endpoint and identity domains.
- Reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) to high-severity security incidents by 40% through implementation of Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks automating alert enrichment, initial containment, and stakeholder notification.
- Delivered continuous vulnerability management programme using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and Tenable.io, enabling evidence-based risk prioritisation and measurable improvement in the organisation's vulnerability posture over time.
- Designed a detection rule library in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), reducing analyst alert fatigue and improving signal fidelity across the security operations function.
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification by leading technical remediation activities across endpoint, identity, and network security controls.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) platform, eliminating uncontrolled privileged access and improving the organisation's resilience against credential-based attack techniques.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (Manchester/London/UK)